

Sheng Wan

Seattle, WA | swan0624@uw.edu | +1 909 991 0548 | shengwan.org

Education

University of Washington, Ph.D. in Political Science (Expected 06/2029)	2024 – Present
• Subfields: Political Methodology, Comparative Politics, Political Theory • Relevant Coursework: Causal Inference, Mixed-Methods Design, Maximum Likelihood Estimation, Data Visualization	
University of Washington, M.A. in Political Science	2026
University of Virginia, B.A. in Politics (Foreign Affairs)	2024

Professional Experience

AI Model Evaluator & Data Specialist, Outlier AI, Mercor, and Handshake AI	2024 – Present
• Designed evaluation rubrics that translate accuracy, instruction-following, harmfulness, and writing quality into explicit criteria for assessing LLM responses. • Constructed political science and political theory prompts and reference answers to test multi-step deductive reasoning; rated response pairs and wrote improvement feedback for training data. • Produced RLHF preference rankings with written rationales and designed adversarial prompts to test model safety, factuality, and instruction-following. • Evaluated Chinese language model outputs for accuracy, fluency, and cultural fit, flagging localization issues. • Reviewed peers' annotations (5+ projects), giving calibration feedback to align contributor outputs with project guidelines.	

Personal Projects

Product Search Quality Analysis	2026 GitHub
• Built a local PySpark and Spark SQL pipeline to clean, join, and analyze 1.82 million query-product judgments from the public Amazon ESCI dataset. • Trained a search relevance classifier using 17 text-match features and logistic regression; kept queries separate across training, validation, and test sets to prevent data leakage. • In an offline audit simulation, prioritizing low-confidence “Exact match” predictions found 32.9 errors per 100 checks, versus 19.9 expected under random sampling, at the same 10% review budget.	
Amelia-Torch: Missing-Data Imputation with PyTorch	2026 GitHub
• Implemented Amelia's missing-data imputation method in PyTorch, with CPU/GPU execution and Python/R interfaces for statistical analysis. • Benchmarked three public datasets (100,000 rows each); on the 90-variable task, native PyTorch CUDA completed five imputations in 22.1 s versus 230.6 s for serial R Amelia and 121.7 s for four-worker R—10.43× and 5.50× speedups (same host; RTX 3080, float64). • Built automated tests and reference comparisons to check numerical behavior and preserve observed data; documented narrower native feature coverage, workload-specific performance, and remaining statistical validation gaps.	

Research

Does Digital Feminism Provoke Population-Level Backlash? Evidence from the #MeToo Movement in China Working Paper

Presented at the Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Annual Conference, April 2026

- Designed a difference-in-differences study of attitude change around China’s 2018 #MeToo movement using eight waves of the Chinese General Social Survey (2010–2023; 70,000+ pooled respondents).
- Cleaned and imputed repeated cross-sectional survey data; harmonized five attitude items into a gender-egalitarianism index for consistent measurement across waves.
- Assessed pre-treatment trends using event-study estimates and checked robustness through other placebo public opinion DVs, and used strong qualitative analysis to show that the result is not caused by general trends of liberalization.
- Estimated heterogeneous effects across gender to identify if the interactions between gender and internet exposure drive attitude change. No evidence for a population-level male backlash was found.

Skills

Data Analysis & Tools: R (tidyverse, fixest, ggplot2); Python (Pandas); SQL (basic); LaTeX

Project Tools: PyTorch, PySpark, Spark SQL

Causal Inference & Research Design: Maximum Likelihood Estimation, Difference-in-differences, Synthetic Controls, Regression Discontinuity, Instrumental Variables

Survey Research: National survey data (CGSS, 70,000+); index construction; cross-wave harmonization; weighting

AI Evaluation: Rubric design, RLHF preference data, red-teaming, multimodal annotation, annotation quality review

Languages: Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent), Japanese (intermediate; two years of university coursework)

Teaching & Communication

Teaching Assistant & Guest Lecturer, University of Washington 2024 – Present

- Led weekly discussion sections for five undergraduate courses (50+ students per quarter), clearly communicating abstract theories and research methods to general audiences.
- Delivered a guest lecture to 80 students on Tocqueville’s *Democracy in America* (POL S 310, January 2026).

Awards & Fellowships

Humane Studies Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies (IHS) 2025